get paid, but has no conception of *why* the taxi system of New York works. Policy institutions in advanced economies have been refined for hundreds of years, and most people in close proximity to those institutions lack an awareness of *why* things work. To do public policy in India, we need to think like an engineer (what are all the moving parts, and the incentives that hold them together) and not a driver (a practitioner who operates in a given institutional apparatus).

Seeing the invisible infrastructure at work

When we look at one narrow piece of a policy puzzle, e.g., in the health system in France, we fail to see the 'invisible infrastructure' upon which it depends. A large number of elements of state policy interact with the visible decisions of health policy to add up to the successful French health system. A front-line worker in the French health system does her job reasonably well because there is invisible infrastructure of the civil servants HR process through which she will face sanctions for not doing her job well. A visitor to France who focuses on studying the health system may admire many design elements of the French health system. But these are often not transferable into a different context, where the invisible infrastructure is lacking. Visitors tend to see elements of health-system design in France and not notice this invisible infrastructure.

As an example, we in India look at the US Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) and think of it as roughly analogous to SEBI. We often fail to see the capability of the US *judicial* system, through which 'Administrative Law Judges' (ALJs) hear cases brought by the US SEC. Hearings at the SEC are conducted by *judges*, not by SEC employees, and the separation of powers at the SEC is protected. This is made possible by the invisible infrastructure of a well-functioning legal system. We in India have an inferior arrangement, where the SEBI Act does not enshrine the separation of powers. SEBI employees who also perform legislative and executive functions, and lack judicial independence, are performing the